

DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUS, IT'S ALL HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:

We explore the world of CGI and check out Holographic Data Storage based on nanoparticle films technology. Level-Up shows you how to achieve a Stock Android look on any phone.



Canon's pocket printer

Canon has launched its smallest printer yet with the Ivy Mini Photo Printer that can print 2x3 Zink photos. Zink is a special type of paper that has embedded ink crystals that does not need ink cartridges.

<https://dgit.in/CanonIvy>

WHAT'S NEW

Chrome's desktop browser now supports web-based VR on the Oculus Rift

A reddit user has discovered that Google's desktop browser has included web-based VR support for the Oculus Rift. If you have the version 66.0.3359.117, go to its 'flags' settings by typing "chrome://flags" in the address bar. Once you're there, look for the new 'Oculus browser support' listing. If this flag is enabled then Google Chrome will be able to use the Facebook-owned Oculus' VR headset to let you experience VR content on the web. Pretty neat, right?

To experience such content, one good place is the WebVR experiments section on Experiments with Google (<https://dgit.in/ExWebVR>). WebVR is an application programming interface based on JavaScript that enables virtual reality experiences in a browser without requiring additional software. It is capable of detecting the virtual reality headset, determining its specifications, getting the position and orientation information from it, and use that to provide frame rates that are supported both by the PC's graphics card and the headset itself. Chrome had added support for WebVR for Daydream based headsets earlier in September 2017.

Here is a full list of VR headsets and the browsers that they support WebVR with:

- HTC Vive: Firefox, Servo, and Supermedium (Windows / Firefox Nightly (MacOS))
- Oculus Rift: Firefox, Servo, Supermedium, Chrome (Windows)
- Samsung Gear VR: Oculus



Browser, Samsung Internet

- Daydream: Chrome
- Google Cardboard: Chrome
- Windows Mixed Reality headsets: Microsoft Edge / Firefox and Supermedium via SteamVR
- PlayStation VR: no support

For now, Chrome on the desktop appears to only support Oculus Rift, however, the year has just begun and the developments will continue to expand.

<https://dgit.in/ChromeVR>



Intel axes wearables division

According to The Information, Intel's wearables division is being shut down. Despite significant investment over the years and multiple acquisitions, the division's innovations failed to make a mark in the wearables market.

<https://dgit.in/IntelAx>



Alexa is getting custom responses

Amazon has introduced easy-to-customise templates for Alexa skills that make it easy for anyone to customise Alexa's responses depending on their needs. Alexa Skill Blueprints can range from a personal joke to custom responses for your babysitter.

<https://dgit.in/AlexaBlu>



eBay app lets you scan barcodes

If you have the box for an item, you just have to scan its barcode (or search by name) and choose the item's condition. After that, the app can fill in a basic description, photos and even the starting price using a mix of structured data and predictive analytics.

<https://dgit.in/eBayBar>